

Building with the machine · Anchor I: The audit lab

What is this sheet about?

This sheet is about what happens after the machine hands you a first screen. You drive your generated output into three recognizable states and keep a protocol of every decision while you work. Then the iterated UI goes into a peer audit along the audit grid, and you answer every finding in writing – accept with the change you will make, or refute with the argument. Unanswered findings are the only wrong option.

Organisation: Work in teams of three, four only if the numbers do not divide, because the audit runs in a circle through the team.

On this sheet, the letters A, B, C and D stand for the team members; in a team of three there is no D. Settle who is who before the first assignment.

What you take with you: At the end of the session, **every person** holds an iteration protocol (assignment 2), an audit of the peer UI (assignment 3) and written responses (assignment 4) of their own. Every tool run gets a four-line protocol entry: tool, prompt, post-editing, time. The sheet has no upload of its own; the protocol feeds Part B and the seminar paper, the audit the seminar paper's audit element.

First assignment (20 minutes): Lay your generated first output on the table, unfiltered, exactly as you brought it. The deliverable is the protocol of what you do with this output; the output itself goes into no grade.

The bridge task from Topic 4 is voluntary and goes on the Padlet, so this sheet does not depend on it. If you have no first output, generate one now from your design question (one prompt, one screenshot, the four-line protocol entry), or start from specimen B, C or D of the Topic 6 lab; they are in Moodle with their audit questions. If you have no tool at hand, work on paper with the fallback from Topic 5: sketch the reduced variant and the one-handed variant, keep the protocol format *decision · reason · discarded*, and note it as *"tool: paper, no model"*. A paper state counts as a state.

Then take out the card with the three audit questions *your* UI must survive, written for the Topic 5 bridge. Sharpen it after what the audit lab in Topic 6 showed you: replace any question that found nothing. If you have no card, write one now. One card, three questions, drawn from your design question and its context. The grid in assignment 3 already covers questions like *"Is the contrast okay?"*. Hand the card face down to the team member who will audit your UI in assignment 3. They open it only after their own grid pass.

Second assignment (50 minutes): Iterate on your first output. Start from the two twelve-minute variants you forced in Topic 5 and drive them further, so that three recognizable states exist:

- **State 1:** the first output (as generated).
- **State 2:** a reduced variant without anything the design question does not need.
- **State 3:** a one-handed or otherwise constrained variant (one-handed use, smallest supported screen, or offline start; pick the constraint your design question makes most plausible).

Write the protocol while you work, in the format from Topic 5: per change one protocol line, *decision · reason · discarded*. Fragments are allowed, and *"ran out of time"* is an admissible line. Per tool run, add the four-line protocol entry: tool, prompt, post-editing, time.

Third assignment (60 minutes): The audit rotation: A audits B's UI, B audits C's, C audits D's, D audits A's; in a team of three the circle closes as A audits B's, B audits C's, C audits A's. You audit the *iterated* state, on the owner's device or export.

Work in two layers:

- **Layer 1, the grid** from Topic 6: four lines, one verdict each: information hierarchy · missing functions (check the states a screenshot does not show: empty and loading, error, success, offline, help. For help: invent a plausible problem and check whether the help reachable from this screen solves it) · WCAG basics (contrast, touch target size, labels; hold the device in one hand and check whether the targets are within thumb reach) · consistency with the platform's patterns.
- **Layer 2, the owner's three questions:** now open the card from assignment 1 and audit strictly along those three questions. Note where the owner's questions and the grid disagree about what matters.

Rank all findings by severity with the rubric from exercise sheet 02; the ranked list is your audit deliverable. Write findings so the owner can act on them: what you saw, where, and why it hurts which user. As in Topic 6, every finding names its anchor (grid line, owner's question or rubric criterion); a finding without an anchor does not count.

Fourth assignment (35 minutes): Take back the audit of your own UI and respond to **every** finding in writing: **accept** (with the change you will make) or **refute** (with the argument). Unanswered findings are the only wrong option.

Close with one sentence: which finding could a checklist not have produced, and which knowledge did it require? If your audit contains no such finding, write exactly that down.

Keep your iteration protocol (with the three states as screenshots or exports), your audit sheet and your written responses. The protocol lines feed the discarded alternatives that Part B (in Exercise U4, upload Fri 20 Nov) and the seminar paper ask for. The audit and your responses are the rehearsal for the seminar paper's mandatory audit element (final-presentation question: *"Your auditor found X. Accept or refute – in writing."*).